

Appendix ApxDD

Contents

The appendix contains details screenshots and other evidence (emails, etc) relating to two occurrences of Octopus taking an amount via DD contrary to clear instruction not to do so.

Background

Direct debits, when they work well, are a great convenience to both the customer and the business using them. Minor amendments can be dealt with without over-heavy process - and a reasonable and well understood degree of flexibility can save time for all parties.

However, the direct debit scheme relies on mutual trust. Trust that a supplier will not overstep the mark in pursuit of own commercial interest, that they will always give sufficient notice of any variance - proportionate to amount of variance in question (it will be easy for some customers - at least - to accept a variance of 10 or 20 pounds with a few days notice - perhaps. It is completely unreasonable to expect a consumer to be able to provide hundreds of pounds in additional funds at short, or even long term notice.

By short term I'm thinking of around a week's notice. No less. By long term I'm thinking of around a full calendar months notice.

Each case is of course, unique, however I was surprised - as per the below - that a professional organisation like Octopus did not seem to have my understanding of how these things should work. We live and learn. I have certainly learned, the hard way it seems.

Issue One - 05-06-23 - £528, agreed amount £300

03:00



octopus



Activity

Wednesday 5



Octopus

(width=50%)

As per this image, 528 was taken on the date shown.

Please see the following emails: thread 1: regarding increasing my DD amount: * 19 May - Octopus seek 'authorisation' to increase the DD amount to £528.00. * 20 May - My response. Not at the moment. I explain information I'd need to review this matter correctly. * 22 May - Octopus respond - seemingly telling me they're happy to provide information I requested and going of their way to point out *they have not changed the DD without my consent*

- THEY THEN TOOK THE MONEY CONTRADICTING THEIR OWN RESPONSE!

In their response to me they went out of their way to say that (I quote):

"... However, we would like to clarify that we did not set the direct debit amount without your consent. We suggested a change to your direct debit amount based on your energy consumption to ensure that your payments cover your usage and prevent any debit on your account. We understand that you would like to keep your direct debit amount the same, and we can certainly accommodate that request..."

(which would be a fine sentiment, had they not JUST TAKEN THE INCREASED MONEY IN ANY CASE!)

- nb: I did not point blank refused their request, I did say I'd need access to certain information (my hope in asking them was that it would appear in a structured manner, easy to digest - however sadly I was terribly naive, it would seem, at the time).